City Council Agenda Report

ITEM NO. 15

DATE: August 19, 2026

FROM: Todd Hileman, City Manager

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SUBJECT: **CONSIDERATION TO DISCUSS THE SOUTH PASADENA POLICE DEPARTMENT'S EVALUATION OF PROSPECTIVE VENDORS PROVIDING AUTOMATED LICENSE PLATE READER (ALPR) TECHNOLOGY AND PROVIDE DIRECTION REGARDING VENDOR SELECTION AND CONTRACT NEGOTIATIONS**

Recommendation

It is recommended that the City Council review and discuss the South Pasadena Police Department's (SPPD) evaluation and analysis of prospective vendors offering Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) technology and provide direction regarding vendor selection.

Executive Summary

At the March 18, 2026, City Council meeting, SPPD presented an overview of the City's contracts with ALPR provider Flock Safety and suggested three options in relation to two separate contracts with Flock Safety, given the concerns that were brought forward regarding policies on data retention, data sharing and the aggregation of data. Council voted to cancel the City's expiring contract with Flock Safety for 14 cameras that was due for renewal, and keep 13 cameras for 5 months while SPPD would search for alternative vendors and systems.

Staff were directed to present a report in August 2026 in relation to available alternatives and provide an update to the City Council. The report is to inform the Council about the vendors that SPPD has been in contact with and the appropriate services and prices they offer, for City Council to review and provide directions concerning the future of the City's ALPR program.

Background

Beginning in 2013, SPPD implemented mobile, or vehicle mounted ALPR technology. In support of expanding this capability, the City's Adopted Budget for Fiscal Year 2022/23 included a $30,000 appropriation to implement and fully migrate to a stationary ALPR system. In November 2022, the Police Department partnered with Flock Safety as part of a regional initiative to enhance crime prevention through strategic technology investments utilizing the Department's General Funds.

On November 16, 2022, the City Council approved a two-year agreement with Flock Safety for the installation of 13 stationary ALPR cameras. To fund the first year's installation and

operational expenses of $30,000, an additional $9,550 was appropriated from the City's General Funds to the Police Department's Contract Services account to cover the full cost of installation and annual operations.

On February 14, 2024, the Urban Area Security Initiative (UASI) 2021 grant enabled the Police Department to expand its ALPR network by adding 14 cameras to the existing system, raising the total to 27 cameras. UASI is a reimbursement -based grant and there is a multiyear lag between grant approval and the actual disbursement of funds. Following the grant award, in which Flock Safety was designated as a pre-approved sole- source vendor, the Department implemented the expansion to further enhance its public safety and investigative capabilities.

On April 15, 2026, City Council discussed the Flock ALPR program and raised the following concerns regarding the existing system:

- Vague policies in regard to data sharing
- Cases from other law enforcement departments nationwide that included examples of unauthorized data sharing
- Inconsistent data retention practices

Based on City Council Direction, this contract was not renewed and the 14 cameras associated with it were fully removed during the month of May, 2026. At that meeting, per the City Manager's suggestion and the City Council's directive, staff was instructed to explore other ALPR providers within the next 6 months and present suggestions in relation to the possibility of incorporating a hybrid model (keeping Flock Safety and adding another ALPR vendor) and present potential alternative vendors on the City Council meeting of August 19, 2026.

Analysis

Automated License Plate Readers (ALPRs) are camera-based systems that automatically capture, digitize, and read license plate information from vehicles as they pass through designated locations throughout a city. These systems use optical character recognition technology to read plate numbers and cross-reference the data against law enforcement databases to identify vehicles of interest, including stolen vehicles, those associated with wanted suspects, or plates linked to amber alerts and other public safety concerns.

Evaluation Process

Per City Council direction, staff evaluated and analyzed the ALPR solutions offered by three vendors: 1) Axon, 2) Motorola, and 3) SoundThinking, and their ability to interoperate with existing regional ALPR networks of law enforcement agencies within the Greater Los Angeles area.

The choice of the above-mentioned vendors is due the fact that they are, to a degree, already integrated into SPPD's operations: Axon is the provider of SPPD's body worn cameras and tasers, Motorola is the provider of the Department's Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) system and SoundThinking's Crime Tracer program is being used by SPPD Detectives.

The evaluation considered the following criteria based on the concerns expressed by City Council and community:

- System functionality;
- Data retention and sharing policies;
- Interoperability, security, operational capabilities;

- Long-term suitability for the City's law enforcement needs;
- Security and privacy features; and
- Overall value.

SoundThinking's PlateRanger addresses the concerns raised by the City Council by meeting the following criteria:

- Configurable data retention to fit our policy
- Data sharing is optional, no automatic nationwide inclusion. California is blocked from participation in the Sharing Network and is used in “California-only” mode
- No default sharing. Sharing must be approved, and access can be blocked when necessary
- Can (and will) require a case number and search reason
- CJIS-compliant security architecture with AES-256 encryption, TLS 1.2+ in transit, multi-factor authentication, and SOC 2-audited infrastructure

- SPPD data is not sold or shared with third parties

- All user activity is tracked and logged for administrative auditing

Ultimately, all three systems provide mature ALPR capabilities that support vehicle identification, investigative searches, officer safety, and regional crime investigations. The primary distinctions between the platforms involve ecosystem integration, investigative tools, interoperability strategy, and the degree to which each solution aligns with the City's existing technology investments and long-term operational objectives.

To ensure a fair, consistent, and comprehensive evaluation of each proposed solution, staff distributed a standardized vendor evaluation questionnaire to all participating vendors. The questionnaire requested detailed information regarding system capabilities, interoperability, data retention and privacy practices, implementation requirements, maintenance, ongoing support, and pricing. Vendor responses were used to inform the comparative analysis and recommendation presented in this report.

Axon

Axon's ALPR platform is designed as part of the company's broader public safety ecosystem, integrating with Axon Fleet in-car video systems, Axon Evidence, and other digital evidence management tools. This integrated approach provides agencies with centralized evidence management, configurable user permissions, audit logging, and data retention settings that can be tailored to agency policy and applicable California law. The platform is particularly advantageous for agencies that currently utilize other Axon products, as it reduces administrative complexity and allows officers and investigators to access ALPR data within a unified environment. While Axon supports third-party integrations through application programming interfaces (APIs), interoperability with external ALPR systems generally depends on the willingness of participating agencies to exchange data and on the availability of compatible interfaces.

Axon representatives have confirmed that SPPD would retain complete ownership of all ALPR Data retention/privacy. Other key takeaways are the following:

• Adjustable retention period based on our agency’s policy
• Equipment can be relocated as needed
• Five-year warranty aligned with SPPD’s existing BWC and TASER agreements, with full

equipment replacement at year five
• Contract can be canceled at any time with no penalties or removal fees

Motorola Solutions
Motorola Solutions offers a comprehensive ALPR platform through its Vigilant product line, which includes fixed, mobile, and trailer-mounted cameras integrated with the company's broader public safety ecosystem. The platform is designed to interoperate with Motorola's Computer-Aided Dispatch (CAD), Records Management System (RMS), body-worn cameras, in-car video, command center software, and real-time crime center applications, while also supporting standards-based integration with many third-party systems through APIs. Motorola's cloud architecture allows agencies to retain ownership and control of their data, with configurable retention periods established by agency policy and applicable law rather than vendor defaults. The company emphasizes privacy-by-design principles, encryption in transit and at rest, audit logging, role-based access controls, and customer-controlled data governance. According to Motorola's data processing policies, customer data is not sold, customers retain control over access and retention, and data is deleted following contract termination unless otherwise required or requested by the customer.

SoundThinking
SoundThinking's (PlateRanger) platform offers both fixed and mobile ALPR capabilities with an emphasis on flexibility and investigative functionality. The platform is capable of ingesting ALPR data from compatible third-party camera systems, allowing agencies to leverage existing infrastructure rather than replacing deployed equipment. PlateRanger also integrates with SoundThinking's CrimeTracer investigative platform, enabling investigators to correlate license plate data with additional law enforcement information. SoundThinking states that ALPR data sharing occurs only with agency authorization and that retention policies are configurable, with routine plate-read data generally retained for up to 30 days unless associated with criminal investigations or evidentiary requirements. This approach provides agencies with significant control over information sharing while supporting regional investigative collaboration when authorized. SoundThinking's PlateRanger solution is typically more competitive as a standalone ALPR deployment, particularly for agencies seeking flexible integration with existing infrastructure rather than replacing multiple public safety systems simultaneously.

Evaluation Summary
Compared with Axon and SoundThinking, Motorola occupies a similar position as an enterprise-scale public safety technology provider but differs in ecosystem focus. Axon's ALPR solution is tightly integrated with its Evidence.com digital evidence platform, body-worn cameras, Fleet in-car video, Fusus real-time crime center platform, and drone technologies, making it particularly attractive for agencies already invested in the Axon ecosystem. SoundThinking emphasizes an open-platform approach, integrating its PlateRanger ALPR system with CrimeTracer, SafePointe, ShotSpotter, and numerous third-party CAD, RMS, and real-time crime center applications, making it well suited for agencies seeking interoperability without committing to a single vendor. From a privacy perspective, all three vendors provide agency ownership of ALPR data, configurable retention schedules, audit trails, and access controls; however, retention policies are ultimately governed by agency policy rather than vendor limitations. Overall, Motorola and Axon provide the greatest value for agencies pursuing an integrated end-to-end public safety ecosystem, while SoundThinking offers greater flexibility for agencies seeking to integrate multiple ALPR camera manufacturers or leverage existing infrastructure while enhancing investigative search capabilities.

All three vendors provide CJIS-compliant security, comprehensive audit logging, role-based access controls, and configurable administrative policies designed to support compliance with California statutes governing ALPR systems. Each platform allows agencies to establish local retention schedules and user access policies consistent with City ordinances, state law, and department policy.

Regional interoperability remains an important consideration because numerous law enforcement agencies throughout Los Angeles County utilize different ALPR technologies. Neither Axon nor SoundThinking relies exclusively on a proprietary network for information sharing; instead, both support integration through APIs and authorized data exchange mechanisms. Actual interoperability with Flock Safety or other regional ALPR providers is dependent upon mutual agreements between participating agencies, available technical integrations, and compliance with each agency's data governance policies. Consequently, no single vendor can guarantee unrestricted access to another agency's ALPR data absent established sharing agreements.

Table 1.

Vendor	**Axon**	**Motorola (Vigilant)**	**Soundthinking (PlateRanger)**
Interoperability	Best within Axon ecosystem; supports third-party APIs	Best within Motorola ecosystem; supports third-party APIs	Strong multi-vendor integration; open architecture
Data Retention	Agency-controlled, configurable	Agency-controlled, configurable	Agency-controlled, configurable
Privacy	Encryption, audit logs, role-based access	Encryption, audit logs, role-based access	Encryption, audit logs, role-based access
Installation	Moderate; certified installation	Moderate–High; certified installation	Moderate; flexible deployment
Maintenance	Cloud-managed with remote updates	Cloud-managed with enterprise support	Cloud-managed with remote updates
Total Annual Costs (14 cameras)	$43,484.24	$58,271.84	$39,158.00 (+ a one-time fee of $14,100)

Recommendation

Based on the evaluation criteria established by the City Council, staff recommends SoundThinking's PlateRanger ALPR system as the preferred vendor. PlateRanger provides the SPPD with a strong balance of investigative capability, data privacy, security, and administrative control, including configurable data retention and safeguards that place control of data sharing with the agency. The system also provides CJIS-compliant security and auditing features, and per their policies data is not sold or shared for commercial purposes and that user activity is subject to auditing. Overall, PlateRanger most closely aligns with the City Council's emphasis on maintaining local control over ALPR data while providing the Police Department with an effective and secure investigative tool.

Updated ALPR Policy

Per the City Council's directive from the February 18, 2026, meeting, SPPD has updated its ALPR Policy. The updated ALPR Policy reflects current SPPD practice as well as updates the policy to reflect the guidance of the Attorney General as well as compliance with Senate Bill 54, which prohibits law enforcement from using their resources for immigration enforcement. New provisions have been added regarding prohibited uses of the ALPR System as well as detailed safeguards with respect to the use of the ALPR System, including annual training and monthly audits. Last, a new procedure has been included with respect to sharing ALPR data with other California law enforcement agencies including the requirement of a data sharing agreement.

Fiscal Impact

SPPD has already included funds for ALPR in it's FY26/27 budget in the amount of $39,000.00 in the Departments Contract Services account number 101-4010-4011-8180.

Flock Safety's FY26/27 (second contract year) invoice in the amount of $39,000.00 was paid on April 23, 2026.

Camera removal fee in the amount of $7,000.00 was waived in relation to the terminated contract for 14 Cameras, as a courtesy from Flock Safety.

If the remaining contract with Flock Safety is terminated effective 10/01/2026, the City should expect to receive a refund in the amount $16,134.35 for unused services. If Flock proceeds with charging the City for removal of the cameras, the City will need to pay $6,500.00.

Should the City Council accept SPPD's recommendation, and chose SoundThinking's PlateRanger system, the initial cost for the first year in the amount of $53,258.00 for installation and subscription services for 14 ALPR cameras, will be covered by already budgeted ALPR funds in the amount of $39,000.00 in the Departments Contract Services account number 101-4010-4011-8180 and the remaining $14,258.00 will be taken from the Departments Asset Forfeiture funds.

Commission Review and Recommendation

The item will be reviewed by the Public Safety Commission at a special meeting scheduled on August 13, 2026. A summary of the Commission's feedback will be provided as an Additional Document prior to the City Council meeting.

Attachment:

Attachment No. 1 - Axon 14

Attachment No. 3 - Motorola - 14 L6Qs

Attqachment No. 5 - PlateRanger

Q-823902-46178AO

Issued: 06/05/2026

Quote Expiration: 07/30/2026

Estimated Contract Start Date: 09/01/2026

Account Number: 114482

Payment Terms: N30

Mode of Delivery: AUTO-GND

Credit/Debit Amount: $0.00

SHIP TO	BILL TO
South Pasadena Police Dept. - CA 1422 Mission St South Pasadena, CA 91030-3214 USA	South Pasadena Police Dept. - CA 1422 Mission St South Pasadena CA 91030-3214 USA Email:

SALES REPRESENTATIVE	PRIMARY CONTACT
Adam Smith Phone: 602-751-1798 Email: asmith@axon.com Fax: (480) 463-2201	Andrew DuBois Phone: 6264294251 Email: adubois@southpasadenaca.gov Fax:

Quote Summary

Program Length	60 Months
TOTAL COST	$167,462.40
ESTIMATED TOTAL W/ TAX	$173,936.90

Discount Summary

Average Savings Per Year	$28,007.20
TOTAL SAVINGS	$140,035.98

Payment Summary

Date	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Aug 2027	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Aug 2028	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Aug 2029	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Aug 2030	$41,865.60	$1,618.64	$43,484.24
Total	**$167,462.40**	**$6,474.50**	**$173,936.90**

Quote Unbundled Price:	**$307,515.60**
Quote List Price:	**$209,328.00**
Quote Subtotal:	**$167,462.40**

Pricing

All deliverables are detailed in Delivery Schedules section lower in proposal

Item	Description	Qty	Term	Unbundled	List Price	Net Price	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Program									
B00076	OUTPOST TAP PLAN	14	60	$366.09	$249.20	$199.36	$167,462.40	$6,474.50	$173,936.90
Total							**$167,462.40**	**$6,474.50**	**$173,936.90**

Delivery Schedule

Hardware

Bundle	Item	Description	QTY	Shipping Location	Estimated Delivery Date
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102032	AXON OUTPOST - CAMERA	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102488	AXON OUTPOST - SOLAR PANEL - 100W	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102538	AXON OUTPOST - TOP MOUNT END CAP - STANDARD	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102543	AXON OUTPOST - BATTERY & CHARGER ENCLOSURE - EXTENDED	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102552	AXON OUTPOST - POLE - STANDARD	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102737	AXON OUTPOST - STANDARD SOLAR HARDWARE KIT	14	1	08/01/2026
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102144	AXON OUTPOST - TAP REFRESH ONE - CAMERA	14	1	08/01/2031
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102810	AXON OUTPOST - TAP REFRESH ONE - BATTERY ENCLOSURE EXTENDED	14	1	08/01/2031

Software

Bundle	Item	Description	QTY	Estimated Start Date	Estimated End Date
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102142	AXON VEHICLE INTELLIGENCE - ALPR LICENSE	14	09/01/2026	08/31/2031

Services

Bundle	Item	Description	QTY
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102136	AXON OUTPOST - STANDARD INSTALLATION	14
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102143	AXON OUTPOST - UPGRADE INSTALLATION	14

Warranties

Bundle	Item	Description	QTY	Estimated Start Date	Estimated End Date
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102135	AXON OUTPOST - EXT WARRANTY - CAMERA	14	08/01/2027	08/31/2031
OUTPOST TAP PLAN	102137	AXON OUTPOST - MAINTENANCE	14	08/01/2027	08/31/2031

Shipping Locations

Location Number	Street	City	State	Zip	Country
1	1422 Mission St	South Pasadena	CA	91030-3214	USA

Payment Details

Aug 2027

Invoice Plan	Item	Description	Qty	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Annual Payment 1	B00076	OUTPOST TAP PLAN	14	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Total				**$41,865.60**	**$1,618.62**	**$43,484.22**

Aug 2028

Invoice Plan	Item	Description	Qty	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Annual Payment 3	B00076	OUTPOST TAP PLAN	14	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Total				**$41,865.60**	**$1,618.62**	**$43,484.22**

Aug 2029

Invoice Plan	Item	Description	Qty	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Annual Payment 4	B00076	OUTPOST TAP PLAN	14	$41,865.60	$1,618.62	$43,484.22
Total				**$41,865.60**	**$1,618.62**	**$43,484.22**

Aug 2030

Invoice Plan	Item	Description	Qty	Subtotal	Tax	Total
Annual Payment 5	B00076	OUTPOST TAP PLAN	14	$41,865.60	$1,618.64	$43,484.24
Total				**$41,865.60**	**$1,618.64**	**$43,484.24**

Tax is estimated based on rates applicable at date of quote and subject to change at time of invoicing. If a tax exemption certificate should be applied, please submit prior to invoicing.

Standard Terms and Conditions

Axon Enterprise Inc. Sales Terms and Conditions

Axon Master Services and Purchasing Agreement:

This Quote is limited to and conditional upon your acceptance of the provisions set forth herein and Axon's Master Services and Purchasing Agreement (posted at https://www.axon.com/sales-terms-and-conditions), as well as the attached Statement of Work (SOW) for Axon Fleet and/or Axon Interview Room purchase, if applicable. In the event you and Axon have entered into a prior agreement to govern all future purchases, that agreement shall govern to the extent it includes the products and services being purchased and does not conflict with the Axon Customer Experience Improvement Program Appendix as described below.

ACEIP:

The Axon Customer Experience Improvement Program Appendix, which includes the sharing of de-identified segments of Agency Content with Axon to develop new products and improve your product experience (posted at www.axon.com/legal/sales-terms-and-conditions), is incorporated herein by reference. By signing below, you agree to the terms of the Axon Customer Experience Improvement Program.

Acceptance of Terms:

Any purchase order issued in response to this Quote is subject solely to the above referenced terms and conditions. By signing below, you represent that you are lawfully able to enter into contracts. If you are signing on behalf of an entity (including but not limited to the company, municipality, or government agency for whom you work), you represent to Axon that you have legal authority to bind that entity. If you do not have this authority, please do not sign this Quote.

Exceptions to Standard Terms and Conditions

Rewrite Estimates

Estimated Amounts and Contract Terminations. Any amounts stated as due under existing or terminated contracts — including contract transfer balances carried forward to new or pending contracts — are estimates based on payments received as of the calculation date. These estimates may be adjusted if new contracts are not executed on the anticipated dates or if expected payments are not made.

Refresh Shipment Timing

Technology Assurance Plan (TAP) Refresh Prior to Renewal. For Customers with expiring agreements that include TAP refresh rights, Axon may, in its discretion, ship refresh hardware under the existing contract while renewal or replacement agreements are in progress. Any such shipments will be deemed made under the terms of the existing contract until the new contract is fully executed, after which any applicable updates, fees, or adjustments will apply.

Shipment Timing

Shipment Variance. Estimated shipment dates are provided for planning purposes only and are not guarantees. Axon may ship hardware before or after the estimated shipment date, and failure to meet an estimated shipment date will not, by itself, constitute a breach, provided Axon uses commercially reasonable efforts to meet estimated shipment dates.

Signature

Date Signed

6/5/2026

